INCH/POUND

MIL-S-42069
30 June 1989

# MILITARY SPECIFICATION

## STEREOSCOPE, VISION TESTING

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This specification covers a vision test instrument for certain visual functions and binocular acuity, all at near and distant viewing distances.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

2.1 Government Documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, Standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2)

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to : Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel DPC-RST, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC/NA FSC 6540

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SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

| | |
|---|---|
| PPP-B-601 | Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood. |
| PPP-B-621 | Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner. |
| PPP-B-636 | Box, Shipping, Fiberboard. |
| PPP-B-676 | Boxes, Setup. |

Military

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-P-116 | Preservation, Method of. |
| MIL-L-10547 | Liner, Case and Sheet, Overwrap, Water Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible. |

STANDARDS

Military

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-STD-105 | Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes. |
| MIL-STD-129 | Marking for Shipment and Storage. |
| MIL-STD-147 | Palletized Unit Loads. |
| MIL-STD-794 | Parts and Equipment, Procedures for Packaging of. |

(Unless otherwise indicated copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DoDISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDiss are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI)

| | |
|---|---|
| ANSI C73-11 | Plugs and Receptacles -- General Purpose, 125 volts, 15 amperes, 2-Pole, 3-wire, Grounding Type |

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018)



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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

### 3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Metal parts. Metal parts shall be of cast aluminum, sheet metal and rolled steel bar and rods. All exterior metal parts shall be painted. Corrosion-resisting steel parts shall not be painted.

3.1.2 Glass lenses. Glass lenses shall be of ophthalmic quality and free from imperfections.

3.1.3 Test slides. Test slides shall be made of plate glass specified herein (see 3.3.4).

3.1.4 Base stand. Base stand shall be made of cast aluminum.

3.1.5 Knobs. Knobs shall be made of plastic or metal.

3.2 Style and design. The apparatus shall be essentially a Brewster stereoscope designed with internally contained glass slides which shall be suitably mounted on two rotatable drums, so placed with regard to the lenses that testing is provided at optical distances of 26 feet for distance tests and at 13 inches for near tests. The apparatus shall consist essentially of the base, main body, and septum box as hereinafter described.

### 3.3 Components.

3.3.1 Base. Base shall consist of a metal base stand, and an adjustable parallelogram which shall allow vertical adjustment. A brake shall be provided to permit locking of the vertical positioning at the desired height.

3.3.1.1 Base stand. Base stand shall be a casting of aluminum or other suitable metal designed to provide instrument stability. The side portions of the stand which carry the parallelogram shall be so shaped as to conform to the matching lines of the body with the instrument locked down in order to serve as a protection of the parallelogram during shipment. Felt bumpers shall be attached to the bottom of the metal base stand to protect the top of the supporting table.



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3.3.1.2 Parallelogram. Parallelogram shall provide vertical adjustment of the instrument over a range of approximately 6-3/4 inches to conform to the variations in sitting heights of adults. Parallelogram shall consist of a front and back plate rigidly ribbed and supported. The front plate shall be mounted to follow the movement of the back plate which shall be precisely aligned on centerless rods.

3.3.1.3 Springs. Springs for counterbalancing the weight of the instrument shall be mounted to the front parallelogram plate.

3.3.1.4 Brake. A case friction type brake shall be attached to the right side of the rear parallelogram plate to permit locking at any position along the vertical range.

3.3.2 Main body. Two side plates shall be separated by studs with sheet metal enclosing the top, bottom, and back of the assembly to make up the main body which shall be attached to the parallelogram. The body shall carry two drums for mounting the distance and near test slides. Both drums shall be mounted so that they are rotatable by handles on the right side of the instrument. Within each drum there shall be a diffusing plate and a light bulb with diffusing cap. The brow rest shall be mounted at the front of the main body.

3.3.2.1 Right and left side plates. Right and left side plates shall be of cast iron, aluminum, or other suitable metal, and shall be well ribbed to prevent warpage. The plates shall be rigidly connected and accurately separated by studs. Handles for rotating the distance and near drums shall be attached to the right plate and a viewing window with sheet metal door shall provide access to the distance slides for demonstration purposes. Receptacles for the two light bulbs shall be provided in openings on the left side plate. The lower edge of these plates shall conform to the lines of the base plate sides to protect the parallelogram in shipment.

3.3.2.2 Brow rest. A heavy metal rod joining the two side plates at an upper projection on the foremost end shall act as a separator and as a mount for the brow rest. The brow rest shall be made up of two curved plastic plates mounted to coil springs which are in turn mounted on a metal strip and firmly attached to the above mentioned metal rods by two screws. The coil springs shall allow the rest to conform to the forehead of the individual being examined in order to provide positive positioning before the lenses.



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3.3.2.3 Cover. A sheet metal cover shall enclose the bottom, back and top of the body assembly. The top portion shall be hinged at the back and shall be capable of being raised to provide access to the slides. Spring catches shall engage the side plates when this top cover is closed to provide for adequate rigidity. A sheet metal vane attached to the top cover shall act as a light shield on the distance drum so that all visible illumination is on the slide in testing position. A plastic rod across the front edge of the cover shall act as a handle and also serve as a cover for any sharp projecting edges.

3.3.3 Drums. Two drums shall be provided, a large drum and a near drum. Both drums shall be rotatable by handles attached at the right side plate. A small dot on the handle plate shall rotate with the drum and shall indicate which side is in testing position as it lines up with identifying numerals on dial on the side plate. Retainers shall be on the drums to allow easy installation or removal of the glass slides.

3.3.3.1 Large drum. A large cast drum for distance slides mounted in the rear of the main body shall be machined to carry eight slides in open frames. The drum shall rotate about a horizontal axis accurately positioned with relation to the stereoscope lenses to provide an optical testing distance of 26 feet. Indexing by grooved and ball stops shall provide positive placement of each test frame.

3.3.3.2 Near drum. The near drum shall be similar to the distance drum but shall be smaller and contain frames for only five slides. Drum shall be positioned with relation to the stereoscope lenses to provide an optical testing distance of 13 inches.

3.3.3.3 Dials. Dials mounted on the right side plate beneath each drum handle shall carry large identifying numerals and letters corresponding to the coding of the slides. Slides shall be positioned in the drum so that the appropriate slide is in testing position when the indicator dot on the handle lines up with its code number on the dial. This positioning shall follow normal testing sequence when the handles are rotated clockwise.

3.3.4 Slides. Twelve (12) mounted standard test slides and five (5) separately packaged optional test slides shall be provided with each unit. The slide shall be made of flat glass measured 6-1/2 inches wide, 2-1/2 inches high, plus or minus 1/64 inch tolerance. The slides shall perform the function as outlined in the Minutes and Proceedings of the Armed Forces NRC Vision Committee 27th Meeting and shall be as illustrated in the Manual of Instructions, Armed Forces Vision Tester, current edition. The slides listed below are for identification purposes.



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| Test Number | Slide Designation | Function |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | D - 1 | Far vertical phoria. |
| 2 | D - 2 | Far lateral phoria. |
| 3 | D - 3 | Far letter acuity (small letters). |
| 3A | D - 3A | Far letter acuity (small letters). |
| 4 | D - 4 | Far letter acuity (large letters). |
| 4A | D - 4A | Far letter acuity (large letters). |
| 5 | D - 5 | Fusion and depth perception. |
| 5A | D - 5A | Fusion and depth perception. |
| 6 | N - 6 | Near vertical phoria. |
| 7 | N - 7 | Near lateral phoria. |
| 8 | N - 8 | Near letter acuity (small letters). |
| 9 | N - 9 | Near letter acuity (large letters). |
| (#) 10 | D - 10 | Far ring acuity - illiterates. |
| (#) 11 | D - 11 | Far binocular letters acuity. (small letters). |
| (#) 12 | D - 12 | Far binocular letter acuity. (large letters). |
| (#) 13 | N - 13 | Near binocular letter acuity. (small letters). |
| (#) 14 | N - 14 | Near binocular letter acuity. (large letters). |
| 15 | ------ | Cancelled. |

(#) designates as optional test (not mounted on drums).

A small pressure-sensitive label shall be adhered on an end of the slide stating its designation number and function.

3.3.5 Illumination. The brightness of the white background of the acuity and depth slides shall be between 10 and 15 foot lamberts. The dark areas shall be dark enough so that only the test targets themselves are visible to the subject, and the borders, septa, etc., are invisible.



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3.3.5.1 Bulbs, sockets, switch, and wiring. Within each drum shall be mounted a 1000 hour, 120 volt, 25 watt, inside frosted show case bulb. The lamp in its socket shall be inserted into medium base receptacles mounted in the left side plate, and shall be held in position by a bayonet lock on the socket. Sockets shall be of the standard spring contact type. An on-off toggle switch controlling both lamps simultaneously shall be incorporated on the operator's side of the instrument. All wiring passing through the side of the instrument shall utilize insulated opening. A nine (9) foot 3 conductor flexible 15 ampere electrical power cord with a 2 pole 3 wire grounding type plug (3 prong) shall be provided in accordance with ANSI Standards C-73.11 .

The minimum conductor size of the cable shall be #18 American Wire Gage (A.W.G.).

3.3.5.2 Illumination cap. A cap made up of open circular metal bands attached to a long metal strip shall slip directly over the end of each light bulb and shall be stopped by a right angle band of the connecting strip. The cap shall be constructed to provide an even illumination of the test slide when used in conjunction with the diffusing glass.

3.3.5.3 Indicator lights. Two small red filters shall be inserted in openings in the right side plate in the position of the distance and near drums. These filters shall act as tell-tale or indicator lights and shall be illuminated by the lamp within the appropriate drum.

3.3.6 Septum box assembly. At the forward end of the main body shall be a septum box movable about its horizontal axis at the eyepoint plane to permit proper angular positioning for distance and near testing. The box shall be attached to the side plates at their extreme forward projection and shall be provided with stops for the two angular testing positions. The stereoscope lenses shall be mounted on the form plate of the septum box. Directly behind these lenses and within the box shall be the variable prisms with their adjustment handles extending above the housing. A system of baffles and an occluder shall be a part of this assembly.

3.3.6.1 Septum box housing. The housing of the septum box shall be of sheet metal. A sheet metal apron at right angles to the bottom plate shall extend downward at the end nearest the test slides. When the box is in its upper position for distance testing, this apron shall cover the near slides and eliminates light from the near drum. The instrument identification shall be silk screened on the apron.



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3.3.6.2 Front or lens plate. The front or lens plate shall be of heavy gage sheet metal and shall be attached to the housing by small screws in its periphery. Apertures for the stereoscope lenses and for nasal clearances shall be provided in its plane surface. Wings at either side shall be bent at right angles to the lens surface. The septum box shall be adjustably attached to the foremost projection of the side plates by a screw hinge connection with the wings of the lens plate.

3.3.6.3 Stereoscope lenses. Each of the stereoscope lenses shall be held in the lens plate aperture by means of a two-piece screw type lens mount, firmly locked in position.

3.3.6.3.1 Lenses. Two decentered 3.00 diopter lenses shall be used in the instrument. Lenses shall be matched for focal length and vertical and lateral positioning of the centers shall be held to tolerances sufficiently rigid to prevent interference with test scores.

3.3.6.4 Prisms. A 2 A stationary prism paired with a rotatable 4 A prism providing known lateral or vertical variations shall be mounted in the septum box directly behind each stereoscope lens. These variable prisms shall be used as a check on malingering in the phoria tests. Handles extending above the septum box shall permit manipulation in accordance with testing practice.

3.3.6.5 Baffles. A system of metal baffles within the septum box housing shall separate right and left eye views of slides, controlling the area of field seen by either eye.

3.3.6.6 Occluder wing. A metal occluder wing shall be mounted within the septum box. This wing shall be so positioned and designed that it may be rotated before either eye for monocular testing. In binocular tests, the occluder shall be designed so that it may be placed in its central position and shall become a part of the system of septa. A wing handle projecting below the septum box shall allow manipulation as required. The handle shall also be capable of indicating the position of the occluder.

3.3.6.7 Viewing angle. A viewing angle of 15° for distance slides and 35° for near slides shall be a requisite for this instrument. Slides shall be set in position for such a visual posture and the septum box shall be positively located by a pair of spring and ball stops housed in projections of the side plates and engaging two accurately positioned holes in the wing of the lens plate. The total range of movement shall be further controlled by a knurl headed stop screw in the left slide plate.



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The end of this screw shall ride in an arced slot in the right wing of the lens plate with the length of the slot limiting the range. For replacement of the near point slides this stop screw shall be capable of being withdrawn to allow the septum box to drop sufficiently for access to the near point drum. An additional safety stop for this extreme downward position shall be assured by an outward lip on the upper edge of the lens plate wings. These small projections shall strike against the inside boss which housed the ball and spring stops on the side plate.

3.4 Finish. The instrument shall be finished in a combination of smooth and shrivel ophthalmic grey with indicator dials. Instrument identification shall be marked with black lettering. The plastic head rest shall be of a similar grey. Other plastic parts shall be milk white.

3.5 Nameplate. The manufacturer's nameplate and electrical plate shall be attached on the lower forward side of the front parallelogram. The following information shall be included: model and serial numbers, wattage, voltage, and hertz.

3.6 Dust cover, illustrator, score key, record forms, and instruction manual.

3.6.1 Dust cover. Each vision tester shall be furnished with a dust cover made of plastic sheet to protect the machine when it is not in use.

3.6.2. Illustration and scoring key. A small rectangular lucite block to be used for explanation of the stereoscopic effect test shall be furnished. This illustrator shall be permanently attached to the machine with a sash chain to prevent its loss. In addition, furnish a vision tester scoring key sheet as illustrated on page 14 and 15 in the government furnished manual. It shall be printed on an 8-1/2 by 11 sheet to both sides and laminated between two plastic sheets.

3.6.3 Instruction Manual (Government furnished). Two copies of the manual of Instruction for Armed Forces Vision Tester published by the Armed Forces-National Research Council Committee on Vision, (latest edition at time of delivery) shall be packed in each unit. Instruction booklets, NSN 7610-00-721-9390 shall be furnished by the procuring activity to the contractor for delivery with the unit. If the illustrations of the units, as contained in the manual, do not depict the unit being supplied, the contractor shall cover those illustrations with suitable illustrations for the item being supplied.



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3.6.4 Record forms. One hundred (100) record forms shall be furnished for each unit. The record forms shall be exactly as illustrated on page 16 of the manual specified above (see 3.6.3). Except on Optional Tests, change "4-S" to "10", change "NS-1 & NS-2" to "11 and 12", and "NS-3 & NS-4" to "13 & 14".

3.7 Performance.

3.71 Mechanical movements. All mechanical movements shall be free and stops positive. Counterbalancing shall allow steady vertical positioning of the instrument if no pressure is exerted. The braking action shall be sufficient to maintain vertical positioning with normal head pressure against the brow rest.

3.7.2 Optical system. The optical system including lenses and slides shall be held to tolerances not to exceed 0.5 prism diopters of lateral or 0.16 prism diopters of vertical displacement at the image plane. The lenses shall make the test patterns crisp and sharp.

3.7.3 Illumination. Illumination shall be between ten and fifteen foot lamberts at the test slide.

3.8 Workmanship. The stereoscope shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.



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4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.3 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, auditory, etc. investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties), of the item.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements and its proper operation. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.5 Inspection of packaging. The sampling and inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

## 5. PACKAGING.

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning and drying. Stereoscope shall be cleaned and dried in accordance with MIL-P-116.



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5.1.1.2 Preservative applications. Preservatives shall not be used.

5.1.1.3 Unit package. One stereoscope shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, Method IA-15. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level C.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. Preservation for stereoscope shall conform to the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. One stereoscope shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, PPP-B-621, class 2, or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall be as specified in the liner specification. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. One stereoscope shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, domestic type, PPP-B-621, class 1 or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. One stereoscope shall be packed in accordance to the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.2.4 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in a exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.



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5.2.5 Unitized loads. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be used whenever total quantities for shipment to one destination exceed 250 pounds or 20 cubic feet. Loads shall be unitized on pallets conforming to MIL-STD-147. Quantities less than 20 cubic feet need not be unitized. Pallet loads including the pallet shall not exceed 43 inches in length, 52 inches in width, and 54 inches in height. Pallet shall conform to Type IV or Type V.

5.2.5.1 Levels A and B. One stereoscope packed as specified in 5.2.1 and 5.2.2 shall be unitized on pallets as specified in 5.2.5.

5.2.5.2. Level C. One stereoscope packed as specified in 5.2.3 shall be unitized as specified in MIL-STD-794.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Levels A, B and C. Each unit pack, intermediate package, exterior container and unitized load shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

5.4 General.

5.4.1 Exterior container. Exterior container (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2, and 5.2.3) shall be of minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

5.4.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.5.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The stereoscope is intended for use as a vision test apparatus for accurate measurement of visual skills and screening of vision defects.

6.2. Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Applicable National Stock Number.
(c) Whether preaward sample is required.
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2)



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6.3 Subject term (key word) listing:

Armed Forces Vision Tester
Automated Vision Tester
Ortho-Rater
Vision Screener
Vision Tester

6.4 National Stock Number (NSN) Coverage. This specification covers the following National Stock Number:

| National Stock No. | Item Identification |
|---|---|
| 6540-00-299-8048 | STEREOSCOPE, VISION TESTING, Near and Distance vision Testing, 115 volt, 60 Hz, AC |

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6540-1214



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| 3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION | 4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)* |
|---|---|
| | ☐ VENDOR |
| b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* | ☐ USER |
| | ☐ MANUFACTURER |
| | ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: |

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

| 7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional | b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional |
|---|---|
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*NOTE:* This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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